

CARDIOVASCULAR DISEASE (CVD) RISK: ROUTINE CARE

Assess the patient with CVD risk

Assess	When to assess	Note
Symptoms	Every visit	Ask about chest pain ↗ 37, difficulty breathing ↗ 38, leg pain ↗ 65 and symptoms of stroke/TIA ↗ 136.
Modifiable CVD risk factors	Every visit	Ask about smoking, diet, alcohol/drug misuse, stress, exercise and activities of daily living. Manage as below.
BMI	At diagnosis, yearly or 3 monthly if trying to lose weight	BMI = weight (kg) ÷ height (m) ÷ height (m). Aim for < 25.
Waist circumference	At diagnosis, yearly or 3 monthly if trying to lose weight	Measure while standing, on breathing out, midway between lowest rib and top of iliac crest. Aim for < 80cm (woman) and < 94cm (man).
BP	Every visit	If known hypertension ↗ 133. If not, check BP: if ≥ 140/90 ↗ 132.
CVD risk (if no known CVD ¹)	At diagnosis, then depending on risk	If < 10% with CVD risk factors or 10-20%, reassess after 1 year. If > 20%, reassess after 6 months.
Diabetes risk	At diagnosis, then depending on result	If known diabetes ↗ 130. If not known with diabetes, check glucose ↗ 17.
Random total cholesterol	If early onset ² CVD in patient/family: at diagnosis	- If early onset² CVD in patient or family history of early onset² CVD or familial hyperlipidaemia, check cholesterol. - If cholesterol > 7.5, check TSH and refer to doctor.

Health for All ↗ 92

Advise the patient with CVD risk

- Discuss CVD risk: explore the patient's understanding of CVD risk and the need for a change in lifestyle. Support the patient to change ↗ 177.
- Invite patient to address 1 modifiable CVD risk factor at a time: help plan how to fit the lifestyle change into his/her day. Explore what might hinder or support this. Together set reasonable target/s for next visit.



Physical activity

- Aim for at least 30 minutes brisk exercise at least 5 days/week.
- Increase activities of daily living like gardening, housework, walking instead of taking transport, using stairs instead of lifts.
- Exercise with arms if unable to use legs.

Health for All ↗ 27



Diet

- Eat a variety of foods in moderation. Reduce portion sizes. Increase fruit, vegetables, nuts and legumes.
- Choose whole grain bread/rice or potatoes rather than white bread/rice.
- Replace brick margarine/butter with vegetable oil or soft tub margarine. Remove skin and fat from meat.
- Reduce salty processed foods like gravies, stock cubes, packet soup. Avoid adding salt to food.
- Avoid/use less sugar.

Health for All ↗ 19



Smoking

If patient smokes, encourage to stop ↗ 141.

Health for All ↗ 33

Weight

Aim for BMI < 25, and waist circumference < 80cm (woman) and < 94cm (man). Any weight reduction is beneficial, even if targets not met.

Health for All ↗ 23



Screen for alcohol/drug misuse

- Limit alcohol intake to ≤ 2 drinks³/day and avoid alcohol on at least 2 days of the week.
- In the past year, has patient: 1) drunk ≥ 4 drinks³/session, 2) used illegal drugs or 3) misused prescription or over-the-counter medications? If yes to any ↗ 142.

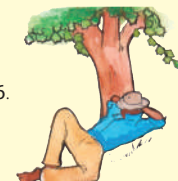
Health for All ↗ 37 and 41



Stress

Assess and manage stress ↗ 86.

Health for All ↗ 100



- Identify support to maintain lifestyle change: health education officer or dietician/nutritionist, friend, partner or relative to attend clinic visits, a healthy lifestyle group, helpline ↗ 178.
- Be encouraging and congratulate any achievement. Avoid judging, criticising or blaming. It is the patient's right to make decisions about his/her own health. For tips on communicating effectively ↗ 176.

Treat the patient with CVD risk

- If **known CVD**¹: give **simvastatin**⁴ 40mg at night. If on amlodipine, give instead **simvastatin**⁴ 20mg at night. Avoid simvastatin if pregnant or liver disease.
 - If patient develops muscle pain/cramps, reduce dose to 10mg at night.
- If **no known CVD**: if CVD risk > 20%, give **simvastatin**⁴ 10mg at night. Avoid if pregnant or liver disease.

Review the patient with CVD risk ≤ 20% yearly. Review the patient with CVD risk >20% 6 monthly. If trying to lose weight, review 3 monthly.

¹Cardiovascular disease (CVD) includes ischaemic heart disease, peripheral vascular disease and stroke/TIA. ²CVD that develops in a woman < 55 years or in a man < 65 years. ³One drink is 1 tot of spirits, or 1 small glass (125mL) of wine or 1 can/bottle (330mL) of beer. ⁴If on lopinavir/ritonavir or atazanavir/ritonavir, avoid simvastatin, give instead **atorvastatin** 10mg at night. No dose adjustment needed for rosuvastatin, pravastatin, atorvastatin.